(meaning I had moved from 100 to 150 in 12 balls), a six over long on and one last six over square leg.

I finished with 162 not out from 66 balls, including 17 boundaries and eight sixes. More importantly, as a team, we had posted an impressive total of 408 for five from our 50 overs. I was exhilarated. We had bounced back from the defeat against India and made a clear statement.

Kyle Abbott then dismissed Chris Gayle in the second over of the West Indian reply, and, with Imran Tahir taking five wickets, we were able to bowl them out for 151. True to plan, the players had fought hard and enjoyed themselves, exactly as I had asked the previous evening.

The little green book had been passed to Rilee, who that night wrote: 'I could write ten pages on today's match, but I only have a little space. We had a fantastic base set up when I got my opportunity and Abbas followed soon after. We both played some great cricket shots, but what I remember most was the enjoyment we were having and playing with the flow of the game. Abbas #spiderman decided to leave nothing to chance and played a SICK innings – "cough, cough" – excuse the pun, leading from the front! It was a memorable day for me and I'm glad my parents were there to see it. Jimmy bowling Gayle, QDK's serious stumping of Sammy and Immy's five-wicket haul. It was an amazing day at the office. I am honoured to be part of this special team. Love you guys. #proteafire.'

That's all we were: a group of young South Africans working hard, giving everything to win this World Cup and to make our compatriots, all our compatriots, burst with pride. There was no dark agenda, no secret plan to deny any kind of opportunity to anybody. We simply wanted to play cricket, and to win.

As usual, the players and coach were the most visible elements of the squad, but there were many dedicated and professional people working tirelessly in the engine room, unseen and largely unappreciated by everyone except us, keeping us fit, motivated and impeccably prepared to perform on the field.